NEXTDECADE

WRITING STYLE GUIDE & RESOURCES 2024

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1.0 Introduction

This evergreen and dynamic style guide is our single-source of information to be used as reference material for any employee or contractor developing communications for internal or external purposes related to NextDecade.

Within this document, we provide information about the preferred writing styles for:

- headlines
- presentations
- e-mail messages
- social media posts
- intranet content
- and more

This style guide also includes photography guidelines, as well as grammar, punctuation, capitalization, abbreviations and other basic information and resources to maintain our unified and consistent corporate voice and messaging.

1.1 Our Voice

Internal to NextDecade

Our written and speaking voice is casual and informal to engage audiences **internal** to our company—employees. These employees comprise teams of leadership (executive and business/function), stakeholders, subject matter experts, managers and others. Our goal is to share these stories in the same way we do with our peers and colleagues—in conversations that are relatable, honest and transparent.

We use inclusive language and pronouns such as “us,” “we” and “our,” as well contractions such as “it’s,” “that’s,” “’we’ve” and others.

Please see **Messaging Framework** and related information on the following pages.

External to NextDecade

Our written and spoken voice is formal to educate and inform audiences who are **external** to our company.

External audiences comprise:

- General public
- LNG and broader energy industries

- Media
- Community members
- Local, state and federal officials
- Shareholders/investors and
- research analysts

Our goal is to share stories that are authentic and transparent in a manner that addresses the interests of each audience by highlighting ways NextDecade is delivering a lower-carbon intensive LNG product and reducing emissions by using carbon capture and storage, responsibly sourced natural gas and using net zero electricity.

We use inclusive but formal language that references areas of discipline such as "engineering team" and NextDecade's engineers." When referring to "ourselves," we say "NextDecade employees/people." We spell out all contractions: "it is," "that is," "'they have" and others.

- Please see **Messaging Framework** and related information throughout the following pages.

2.0 Messaging Framework

2.1 Internal to NextDecade

Our purpose

To deliver content and messaging that increases awareness of what employees should know, feel and do as part of their journey with NextDecade.

Our objectives

To keep employees informed by delivering consistent, timely and transparent information with a regular cadence of content distribution.

To increase employee engagement by providing actionable, relatable, balanced and relevant stories across our business, functions and locations.

To foster and amplify positive employee morale by building employees' understanding of their contribution to the company's strategy, goals and objectives. We approach this with feedback and ideas.

Transparent communication is the act of sharing both positive and negative information across the company in a way that allows all to see the why behind the words. This information can be framed around challenges and/or opportunities for improvement.

Benefits include:

- Increases collaboration
- Enhances trust
- Increases innovation
- Encourages people to communicate openly
- Increases the sharing of ideas
- Allows the workplace to be more informed
    - Demonstrates leadership cares
    - People know the company's direction
    - People better understand the why and what of decision-making

2.2 External to NextDecade

It's important for our business and our Value of Transparency to share information and material with our external audiences on a timely basis. This builds trust and addresses the "why now; why NextDecade" and what differentiates us from our competitors.

Our external audience segments include:

- General public
- LNG and broader energy industries
- Media
- Community members
- Local, state and federal officials
- Shareholders/investors
- research analysts
- Certain parties subject to nondisclosure agreements or nonmaterial information during ordinary business such as equity partners, members of NextDecade Board of Directors, customers, Bechtel and our lending banks

It Is important to share only information that is in public domains (Ex: next-decade.com, newswire releases), even if you may have additional information that has been excluded from public disclosure or may answer questions that provide clarity. <u>If the information is not publicly available, don't share it with anyone and don't include it in written communications.</u>

3.0 Communications Channels

3.1 Internal to NextDecade

Intranet site—employee portal. The intranet homepage is the entry point for all information, resources and material employee and company related

NEXT digest—monthly newsletter that includes a roundup of content posted on the intranet during the month. NEXT digest also includes holiday messaging and promotes programs, services, apps, solicits employee feedback and provides reminders about required actions (as appropriate) that may not have a dedicated intranet story

E-mail

Digital screens

In-person events

- Townhalls
- Lunch and learns
- Information sessions

Promotional items (Stuff We All Get—SWAG) – see **external to NextDecade.** Provided as part of:

- New hire welcome packet
- Community events and more

3.2 External to NextDecade

Next-decade.com web site

Social media

- LinkedIn
- Facebook
- X (formerly Twitter)

In-person events

- Customer/client meetings
- Conferences/workshops

        - See our Conferences, Exhibition, and Speaking Engagements Guidelines. This document establishes consistent review criteria for potential event participation and/or sponsorship. It provides a framework for conference participants to enhance our brand, deliver our message and gain the most value from our commitment
    - Recruiting opportunities
        - Universities
    - Career fairs
    - Community presence
        - Education and information sessions
    - Investor and research analyst meetings and non-deal roadshows

Emails and/or other written correspondence with external stakeholders

Event sponsorships

Media opportunities

- One-on-one leadership/executive interviews

Collateral/take away material

- Fact sheets
- Brochures
- White papers

Promotional items (see Brand & Style Guidelines)

- Shirts
- Mugs
- Golf balls
- Visors
- Reusable shopping bags and more

4.0 Writing Guidelines

4.1 Internal to NextDecade

Headlines/Subject lines

A headline is among the first elements a reader will see when deciding whether to look at a piece of NextDecade content.

Headlines should be short, engaging and include actions (such as sign-up for Benefits now, acknowledging policy receipt by Aug. 1). Where possible and appropriate, headline writing can be creative—play on words, use parts of internal quotes, etc.

Examples:

- Summer safety: Our healthcare providers share resources
- HSSE updates: Houston office expansion, badging, RGLNG site visits
- Schatzman: We made history...
- Don't take the bait: Know how to identify "phishing" and "smishing"

Photo captions/descriptions

Like headline writing, photo captions should be short and engaging. They should identify people and/or location(s) in a compelling summary approach that doesn't state the obvious of the photo content. Include the first and last name, as well as the title of all people represented in a photo.

Examples:

- Patrick Couch, Senior Vice President of Technical Services at Gladstein, Neandross and Associates. The company is a clean transportation and energy consultancy firm with offices in California and New York

- Senior project engineer Connor Rivard waving to senior mechanical static equipment engineer Yoshio Zuniga during the Aramco Houston Half Marathon

E-mail messages (general)

E-mail is an effective channel of communication as it allows direct contact with your intended audience quickly and is accessible from multiple devices, which can be especially helpful in times of urgency.

E-mail template design guidance has been developed using appropriate NextDecade department or leadership banners to align with our branding, reduce perception of phishing attempts and increase engagement through completion of requested action. Download appropriate banner here.

See e-mail communications for writing best practices through this medium. Remember to consider your audience, voice and message framework when drafting your message.

E-mail messages should be concise with the main point or action requested summarized in three or four words in the subject line. Language internal to NextDecade is more casual than that used in the external environment.

E-mail resources:

- E-mail governance and template
- Please download the template and compose your message according to the guidance
- See Appendix for visual representation of e-mail template and sample of department message

Employee messages

See guidelines for communicating with your people to learn how employee messaging plays an integral part in the employee experience. The right cadence and style of messaging to keep employees informed of developments, changes and progress helps employees feel connected to their company and understand their valuable contribution to the company.
Content and messaging increases awareness of what employees should know, feel and do as part of their journey with NextDecade

Presentations—see Corporate PowerPoint Guidelines in Brand and Style Guidelines

5.0 Style and Usage

5.1 General: Abbreviations and acronyms

Our audience's background, skillset, experience and knowledge are diverse. Consider your audience when you are crafting messages and communications.

The full term, word or phrase spelled out the first time (first reference) for clarity followed by the acronym in parentheses. Use the acronym in subsequent references.

If the term is used only once, there is no need to include the acronym in parentheses.

Example:

Process Engineering intern Kamal Tijani said it's important to stay inquisitive about the liquefied natural gas (LNG) world and recognize the roles our Values of Diversity and Transparency play.

Our company names

Our company name is NextDecade. Always spell the full name out—never abbreviate as "ND" or "NEXT"—regardless of the audience—internal or external—or communication channel. "NEXT" refers to our NASDAQ stock symbol.

Calendar months

Months are always spelled out if they are a stand-alone reference to a period of time. If a date follows, reference as below: (*Note: Don't abbreviate months that are short in length)*

- Jan.
- Feb.
- March
- April
- May
- June
- July
- Aug.
- Sept.
- Oct.
- Nov.
- Dec.

Examples:

- The first benefits session is scheduled for Jan. 5, 2023
- The first benefits session is scheduled for April 5, 2023

Date

- Always use the year as four digits following the month and day for archiving purposes. Because most of our communications are digital and archived, it's important to have a full date recorded for auditing purposes.

Example:

- The first benefits session is scheduled for Jan. 5, 2023

Time of day

Use the abbreviations a.m. or p.m. If an event starts in the morning and ends in the morning or starts in the afternoon and ends in the afternoon, it is not necessary to repeat the abbreviation.

Examples:

- The first benefits session is scheduled for Jan. 5, from 10 to 11 a.m.
- The first benefits session is scheduled for Jan. 5 from 1 to 2 p.m.
- The first benefits session is scheduled for Jan. 5 from 11 a.m. to 12 p.m.

5.2 Capitalization

Titles

Capitalize an employee title in all written communications, regardless of placement in the sentence.

Examples:

- "Our team is looking forward to supporting upcoming LNG open houses in the Rio Grande Valley communities," said **Director of Corporate Communications Jane Doe.**
- **Jane Doe, Director of Corporate Communications**, said, "Our team is looking forward to supporting upcoming LNG open houses in the Rio Grande Valley communities."

- "Our team is looking forward to supporting upcoming LNG open houses in the Rio Grande Valley communities," said **Jane Doe, Director of Corporate Communications**.

5.3 NextDecade definitions, acronyms and abbreviations

Note: Consider your audience and their familiarity with the abbreviations before using them in a communication.

NextDecade Acronym Search App (NASA)

5.4 Formatting

Internal e-mails

See e-mail communications for details on template, content and other information. Remember to consider your audience, voice and message framework when drafting your message.

Document briefs, guidelines and other NextDecade should follow the style below

Headline: Font: Segoe UI, Blue, Accent 1, Darker 50%, 20pt

- Body text: unbold black, 11pt
- Subheads: Font: Segoe UI, Blue, Accent 1, Darker 50%, 16pt

Informal document naming convention

When developing informal internal documents that will be posted on your department site, distributed via e-mail or otherwise circulated—such as how tos, tips, guidelines, briefs, application forms, etc. that do not go through Document Control—choose a brief and consistent naming convention that accurately reflects the document contents without a version or application reference. If a version or date is required, note in the page footer.

When uploading to a department site for broad employee access or distributing internally via another communication channel for information sharing/resource purposes only, save the file as a pdf, when possible, to avoid format/content manipulation.

Example Do:

NextDecade employee-submitted photography tips

Example Don't:

NextDecade employee-submitted photography tips.pdf

NextDecade employee-submitted photography tips.docx

6.0 Appendix

6.1 Brand and Style Guidelines

Our Brand Guidelines outline the appropriate use of logos, colors and other digital assets to ensure they uphold the integrity of our brand and our company.

These guidelines include:

- Primary colors
- Typography
- Our logo
- NEXT Carbon Solutions
- Rio Grande LNG
- E-mail signature
- Corporate PowerPoint guidelines
- Promo Item guidelines
- and more

6.2 Resources

Department: Policy and Corporate Affairs

Policy & Corporate Affairs is comprised of Corporate Communications and Community Relations. We work with internal and external stakeholders to tell our company's story, promote our people, share business updates and programs, and support the communities in which we live and work. Our team also contributes expertise to help inform policy decisions that will have an impact on the LNG and natural gas industries.

Quick reference guides

- E-mail communications
- Guidelines for communicating with your people
- (General) Industry Conference participation guidelines
- NextDecade Employee-Submitted Photography Tips

6.3 Templates, Logos

See Templates, Logos for our brand compliant e-mail department banners (see Template and message samples in Appendix), e-mail signature templates, e-mail template, NextDecade and subsidiary (Next Carbon Solutions and Rio Grande LNG) logos and letterhead.

Teams backgrounds

See Teams Backgrounds for brand compliant background options when participating in a video-enabled Teams call. Click here to learn how to change your Teams background.

Examples:

Template and message samples

E-mail

NextDecade e-mail template guidance

- **Download your department header banner here**
- **Headline: Font: Segoe UI, dark blue bold, 14pt**
- Body text: unbold black, 11pt
- **Subheads: Segoe UI, orange accent 2, 12pt**

NEXTDECADE **COMMUNICATIONS**

Headline

maximum of 150 characters or 100 words. High-level overview of your message that includes what you want employees to know, feel or do (is it informational, aspirational or actionable)

Subhead: What's happening and why

Subhead: What this means for you

how it will impact the audience and the action they need to take

Alternative subhead if immediate action needed and move to top of message: Action required by xx

Subhead: When is it happening

- Time, date
- What will be affected (i.e.: systems down,

Subhead: More resources

Link to internal:

- department site(s)
- Document(s)
- Form(s)
- etc.

Have questions?

Contact x department or x person

Sample: Department e-mail

NEXTDECADE

INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY

Cyber security awareness training

According to a recent techjury blog, ransomware was the third-most used form of cyberattack in 2022. E-mail is responsible for 91% of all cyberattacks with zip and .exe file extensions among the most popular malicious e-mail attachments, according to the blog, which cites Deloitte, The Wall Street Journal, Tech Crunch, security firms and more.

Nearly 65% of global companies have experienced at least one form of cyberattack. As we continue to grow, cyber safety is a top priority. It impacts our access, applications and assets. Everyone has a vital role in keeping us cyber safe as the landscape of this security threat continues to evolve and increase in sophistication.

What's happening

Beginning the first quarter of 2023, NextDecade employees will be required to complete security awareness training at least once on a quarterly basis.

The training should take about 5 to 10 minutes to complete and will consist of one to three short videos followed by a quiz.

What this means for you

This training will:

- Increase your awareness and understanding of sophisticated cyber threats
- Provide tools and knowledge to help you secure our intellectual property, recognize and know how to report suspicious activity

What managers need to know

- You are responsible for ensuring your team completes this training before the deadline
- You will also be informed if someone on your team fails to complete the training

NextDecade Corporation (NextDecade) is committed to providing the world access to lower carbon intensive energy through Rio Grande LNG & NEXT Carbon Solutions.

Next steps

- When training is available, you will receive an e-mail notification from our learning and training platform, KnowBe4
- Log into your account and take the training.
    - If you are logging into the platform for the first time, you will be asked to provide your username and password. Enter the same credentials you use to log onto your computer. This is single-sign-on access, so you will not be required to log into KnowBe4 again.

For tips to stay cyber safe, visit Information Technology on What's NEXT - NextDecade Employee Portal

Questions?

Have questions or need more information? Contact it@next-decade.com

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